

SUNDAY 4 OCTOBER 2026

Twenty Seventh Sunday Ordinary Time

MISSION MONTH

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel: 028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 5 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm, Grotto
Tuesday 6 Oct	Mass, 10.00am	Rosary, Castlederg: 2.00pm	Rosary, 10.00am
Wednesday 7 Oct	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion: 10.00am	Castlederg: Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion: 10.00am Dregish: Rosary, 11.00am	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 8 Oct	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 9 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 10 Oct	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm: <i>Month's Mind - Evelyn Baxter</i>	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 11 Oct	Mass on 1 st & 3rd Sunday	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am: <i>First Anniversary: Kay Nugent</i> Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	Mass on 1 st & 3rd Sunday

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £657 & €65; Church Restoration Fund: £430 & €42.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,156 & €67, made up of:

Castlederg £1,375 & €61, **Drumnabey** £428 & €6, **Dregish** £353. **DRUMQUIN:** £752.

As always, thank you very much to all who contribute by Standing Order.

Season of Creation closes today on this Feast Day of St Francis of Assisi, patron saint of the environment and animals. Francis' deep love of God was expressed through his love for all of creation. Today's Gospel reminds us that the vineyard has been entrusted to our care and that God expects it to bear fruit. Caring for God's creation is not an optional extra in our Christian lives – it is one of the ways in which we show our gratitude to God for the gifts we have received. Like St Francis, we are called not only to admire the beauty of creation but to respect and protect it and leave it as a precious gift for those who come after us.

St Francis of Assisi, pray for us.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the souls of Frankie Breen, Dernalear Road, Drumquin, whose Funeral Mass took place in Drumquin on Tuesday of last week and Brendan Cassidy, Meenacloy Road, Killen, whose Funeral Mass took place in Drumquin on Saturday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to their families and to all who mourn their deaths. May they rest in peace.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG Parish Draw: The September draw took place in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg, last Sunday. Congratulations to our winners!

£1,000 Patsy McMenamin (1104) Promoter's Prize: Jimmy McMenamin

£500 Benny Dolan (422)

£250 (x 3) Enda Lynch (825); Mark Quinn (823); Rosey Brogan (206)

£100 (x 7) Siobhan Friel (29); Louis Cassidy (882); Patricia Gallen (649); Janet Harper (1070);

Marie Baird (1030); Kathleen McHugh (212); Stephen Catterson (1054).

Thank you to all who helped on the day, to all our promoters and to all who participate in the draw. Returns for October's draw should be made to the Parochial House on Thurs 15 Oct between 6.00 and 7.30pm. Next draw will take place on Sunday 25 October 2026 in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish. There are just a few tickets left. If you're not in, you can't win!

OCTOBER - MONTH OF MISSION AND MONTH OF THE HOLY ROSARY:

October, Month of Mission, reminds us that sharing the joy of the Gospel is the calling of every baptised Christian - the calling to bring Christ's love, compassion and hope into our families, parish and wider community. It invites us to look at how we can make the Gospel visible, not just to ourselves but, to others as we go about our daily lives. Inspired by the example of St Therese of Lisieux, patroness of the missions, we are reminded that even the smallest acts of love, kindness and generosity are a powerful expression of our missionary calling. Mission Sunday will be celebrated on Sunday 18 October. Pope Leo's theme for Mission Sunday, "**One in Christ, united in mission**," is certainly a reminder that, united in faith, we all have a part to play in sharing the Gospel and bringing Christ's love to others.

The Rosary invites us to reflect on the great mysteries of the life, death and resurrection of Jesus. We are invited to make special effort to pray the Family Rosary in our homes during October. Parents, in particular, are encouraged to teach and pray the Rosary with their children. Please also note the following opportunities in our parishes to pray the Rosary as parish communities:

St Patrick's, Drumquin: The Rosary continues to be recited at the Grotto every Monday evening, at 8.00pm, and in the church every Tuesday at 10.00am.

St Patrick's Church, Castlederg: the Rosary will be recited each Tuesday of October at 2.00pm, led by the Legion of Mary, starting this Tuesday, 6 October.

St Mary's Church, Dregish, at 11.00am on the Wednesdays of October, starting this Wed, 7 October, Feast of Our Lady of the Rosary. Tea and a chat afterwards in the hall.

Our Lady of the Rosary, pray for us.

PASTORAL VISITATION of the housebound will take place this week as follows: **Wed 7 Oct** - Drumquin Town Area - Segully Road, McCrea Park, Castlederg Road, Main Street, Creaghmore Road, Fairgreen Gardens and Loughrey Terrace, commencing at 10.45am - Fr Thomas. **Thurs 8 Oct** - Dregish, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Paul.

LEGION OF MARY meeting in Parochial House, Drumquin, this Thursday, 8 Oct, 7.30pm. New members welcome!.

CASTLEDERG ANNUAL CHRISTMAS BAZAAR: Tuesday 8 December, 7.30pm. To have a successful Bazaar for the parish we need your help, so we are appealing for help for the next couple weeks. If you are willing and able to help, please come along to a **meeting this Wednesday, 7 October, in St Patrick's Hall, at 7.30pm.**

SAVE THE DATE: Sunday 29 November, Dregish Bazaar, at 7.00pm. Put in your diary and spread the word!

AGHYARAN ST DAVOG'S 70th ANNIVERSARY BANQUET: Saturday 14 November in the Villa Rose Hotel. Tickets on sale in the club this Saturday, 3 Oct, from 8.30 to 10.00pm. Cash and card payments accepted. Tickets £50 each and can be purchased individually or in tables of 8/10. Promises to be a great night as we celebrate 70 years of our club, its history and the people who have been part of it along the way. We look forward to seeing you there!

DRUMQUIN HISTORICAL SOCIETY presents **A Tribute to Charlie Kearney**, Songwriter, Poet, Publican, Friend. An evening of Song, Poetry, and Recordings: Drumquin Social Centre, Dooish Road, this Friday, 9 October. Doors open 7.00pm. Starts 7.30 sharp. Everyone is welcome. Adm. £5. Refreshments served.

LINE DANCING: A 6-week Line Dancing class begins in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, starting on Thursday 15 October from 8.00pm to 9.30pm. Admission is £3. This project is funded by the National Lottery

MOTHER EARTH: A 4-week class, using textile hardener and air dry clay to create a scene in a box frame, following the theme of Mother Earth, begins on Tuesday 3 November from 7.00 to 9.00pm, in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish. Total cost is £10. Contact Claire on 07818091136 to book, as numbers are limited. Kindly funded by National Lottery.